

REGULAR MEETING

THURSDAY/SEPTEMBER 6, 2018

SCHOOL COMMITTEE MEETING - CITY COUNCIL CHAMBER, MEDFORD CITY HALL

The regular meeting of the Medford School Committee was called to order by Mayor Burke, in the Council Chamber at 7:06 PM. Those present were: Ms. DiBenedetto, Ms. Kreatz, Ms. Mustone, Mr. Ruggiero, Mr. Ruseau, Ms. Van der Kloot, Mayor Burke, Superintendent Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Associate Superintendent Diane Caldwell, and Assistant Superintendent of Finance Kirsteen Patterson. In addition, Mayor Burke welcomed the new MHS Representative Jasper Su

The secretary will call the roll to approve the minutes of June 18, 2018 – passes 7-0

The secretary will call the roll for approval of bills/transfer of funds. Ms. DiBenedetto, Mr. Ruseau & Mr. Ruggiero all had questions, which Ms. Patterson addressed. Motion for approval of bills/transfer of funds, passes 7-0

Motion for approval of payrolls – motion passes 7-0

Report of secretary – Ms. Kreatz stated – over the summer, I signed bills and reported same to my colleagues. I want to thank Ms. Van der Kloot for covering for me, while I was on vacation. Thanks to all. Motion to approve secretary's report – motion passes

Report of committeesMayor Burke stated report will remain in subcommittee

Ms. Van der Kloot makes motion to take papers out of order. Motion passes, 7-0

Motion is for executive session - roll call vote – 7-0 motion passes. School Committee enters executive session at 7:20 pm to discuss teacher contract.

Superintendent Dr. Edouard-Vincent announced that it was unanimous to ratify MTA contract. Motion by Ms. DiBenedetto to approve, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot. Roll call to ratify – 7-0. MTA contract passes. Ms. Van der Kloot states, what a wonderful way to begin school year, thank you.

Mayor Burke – Report on Opening of Schools – Welcome Madam Superintendent!

Superintendent Dr. Edouard-Vincent - "I am excited to hear of our new student member. We begin our journey here together. There are also several new principals/administrators that I'd like to introduce:

Mr. Michael Downs, Andrews Middle School Principal

Dr. Stacey Mulligan, Assistant Principal, Medford High School

Mr. Stephen Burnham, Assistant Principal, Medford High School

Ms. Kathleen Ciampoli, Coordinator of Special Education

Ms. Faiza Kahn, Supervisor of Mathematics

Superintendent Dr. Edouard-Vincent then showed a video clip on the screen about the opening of the schools, which was produced by Mr. Jack Dempsey.

Mayor Burke – What a wonderful start to the school year. Thank you Dr. Vincent.

Ms. DiBenedetto- Did I hear that Dr. Marice rode a school bus? Superintendent Dr. Edouard-Vincent responded – “Yes I did. I rode Bus #10 to the Columbus School. I surprised the students, the bus driver and the parents. I think I was more excited than they were! All the students were very well behaved”.

Ms. Van der Kloot – People felt this was a great start.

Superintendent Dr. Edouard-Vincent then thanked all of the principals/administrators who have been so helpful over the summer. “I am very fortunate to lead with such a great team”.

Motion to accept report of the opening of schools– the motion passes

Report on building & grounds – Mr. McLaughlin stated below:

“Brooks Field – was a necessary fix, looks great. It used be just a dirt pile. Columbus – new slide could be installed by Monday. McGlynn – roof repairs, will stop any water issues in classrooms. MHS – working to install air conditioning in MEEP program. Also installed, water bottle fill stations which are now functional in both MHS/MVTHS & the cross connection of water was fixed during the water bottle fill station installation

Mr. McLaughlin also stated, “We work very well with DPW and appreciate their assistance. They provided the granite for the brooks field project”.

Ms. DiBenedetto – Thank you for all your good work

Mr. McLaughlin – Working together we can get a lot done

Ms. DiBenedetto- I was hoping for windows to be washed in every building. Mr. McLaughlin – We will try to get to it, school by school, year by year.

Mr. McLaughlin - Currently we are seeking an estimate on air conditioning for Caron Theater.

Ms. DiBenedetto – Update on MHS pool issue?

Mr. McLaughlin – Rachel Perry did an excellent job. John Bavuso from City's Building Department provided a contractor, so we were back on line September 4th.

Ms. DiBenedetto – What were the costs involved? We need to maintain it. It's only 6 years old.

Mr. McLaughlin – Because of our continued maintenance we found problem before it became a big issue. Currently, we are also addressing other items at the Curtis Tufts

Ms. DiBenedetto – How was Brooks turf field payed for?

Mayor Burke – It was paid for by the City's Linkage account. That particular school is not adjacent to a park or within walking difference to one. Costs were under \$50,000

Ms. Van der Kloot - It was a hot start to school year. Did we have issues with our air conditioning units? Mr. McLaughlin - We do have compressor issues in some of our buildings. We have to look into at some point, but that would be an issue for the capital plan, as costs are approximately \$15,000 per compressor. In cases of extreme heat, we were able to move students around to cooler areas of buildings. The Superintendent authorized us to purchase water for all students, including those riding bus home

Ms. Van der Kloot – Please plan to provide us with a follow up report on compressors and where we are.

Mayor Burke – Assistant Superintendent Patterson has a supplemental document to bring to the floor.

Ms. Patterson – Please find the supplemental document in your packets which discusses in depth the timeline for the Roberts School playground. We especially thank Cheryl Rodrigues, for her time and dedication to this project. We are all very excited for this project. You will see this project's timeline began in January of 2018. Our vision is that this will be a superior playground and will have tiles installed. (Tile samples were passed around) The scope of the job includes: removal of old existing playground floor, graded down to specifications and contractor will work around the playground structures. We are definitely making every effort to have this project done right, and to be sustainable. We do not want a quick fix. We hope to get it done before the winter weather.

Mayor Burke – I would add that Danielle, the Administrator of CPC, provided the time line. If city council took separately, it could be expedited. We applaud Ms. Rodriguez for all of her hard work on this project

Ms. Van der Kloot – Do colors mean anything? Ms. Patterson – They are just color choices

Ms. DiBenedetto - I would like to yield floor to Ms. Rodriguez, as well as, acknowledge City Councillor Breanna Lungo-Koehn, who is in attendance. Maybe she can help expedite this request?

Ms. Rodriguez – Roberts is largest elementary school in district. I spoke to many contractors. I called attorney general's office to clarify...Why must we use Massachusetts state wide contracts? I spoke to Brian O'Donnell in the attorney general's office. In 2016, the chapter 30B procurement laws were amended. So material purchases are unlimited and labor costs are now at \$50,000 capped. (Please see Ms. Rodriguez's report) We can move forward now!

Ms. Patterson – This has been an open procurement process. My concern is prevailing wages aren't included in costs. We don't want to further delay process. We have gone through every exercise as required by mass general laws. We can reach out to DCAMM. I would be concerned with speaking with just one single bidder.

Mayor Burke – We received product cost bid from the city's procurement officer

Ms. Patterson – We are not allowed to bid split for large scope projects, providing material and installing, could potentially open us up to a bid protest, further delaying the job. Plus, we require warranties on the project.

Mr. Ruggiero – Should we re-bid the project? I'd like to save \$100,000

Mayor Burke – We have re-bid it twice. It would take at least another month to do another round.

Ms. Van der Kloot – Ms. Rodriguez said could use state contract?

Mayor Burke – The list is for the product, nothing else – pricing the tiles as they are the largest cost, bid the labor.

Ms. Rodrigues – The price includes the labor, not just the tile. If labor costs are under \$50,000, you do not have to bid that cost. I would encourage someone to sit with me and go over this.

Ms. Van der Kloot – Would it be possible for everyone to sit down? Clearly we want the playground done. So can I make motion, that procurement, Ms. Rodriguez, Ms. Patterson, Mr. McLaughlin, & contractor, sit down and see if there is a way to move forward?

Christina Gasson – a member of Roberts PTO & an attorney for the state – I would recommend to open lines of communication to make sure everyone is on same page. There is several state

resources open to municipalities to help with differences between listings. COMMBUYS can do bid for you. We want it done as soon as possible.

Ms. Patterson – We are required to list in COMMBUYS. We did use all the outlets available to us

Ms. Van der Kloot – I made a motion ... everyone wants same thing ...

Mr. Ruggiero – I would add to your motion, that the city solicitor be added to that meeting, if possible

Ms. Mustone – I'm still unclear of the (2) different processes. Cheryl can you clarify?

Ms. Rodriguez - Removal, disposal & purchase of playground, blocks are done separately. Groundmasters could do removal, itemized bid with company you worked with before. Execute contracts, begin work and pay it out

Mr. McLaughlin - Groundmaster was going to take it out and grind it, they were always on board

Ms. Rodriguez - \$130,000 for installation - \$90,000 for tiles

Mr. McLaughlin – You want company to lay foundation for tiles (sheet for tile)

Mr. Ruseau - Every contractor has different prices/warranties etc. The plans were very detailed. To be fair it has to be the same details with the same bids

Ms. DiBenedetto – We want what was initially presented to CPA. That's what we are looking to get done. I don't know if the project became more elaborate? We are piloting this program

Ms. Van der Kloot - I still have a motion on the table. Cheryl has invested a lot of time...

City Councillor Lungo-Koehn - I'm a parent of children at Roberts. As we have seen, projects have already been completed at other schools. This is a safety issue now. Please research and talk to these companies. This project should take one week! Cheryl needs to be involved. Please explore all outlets. I don't know why this hasn't already been done? Contractors that do this type of work should be the ones to get it done.

On the motion – Ms. DiBenedetto – That we talk to other contractors if Kirsteen could reach out to other bidders

Roll call vote on the motion to have all parties meet – 7-0 motion passes –

Mayor Burke - We will get parties together along with John McLaughlin to do further research

Ken Krause – I'm just an interested citizen. I'm not involved in any of the schools. Just very happy field at Brooks was addressed. I know linkage money was used, but community should know that PTO contributed financially to the project. Also, I wondered if there is a maintenance budget attached to it. Also is infill replenishing included, so that other fields are maintained? This will be used daily and was a safety hazard. Lastly, what is the update on work by Lesley University? The basketball floor final sanding was completed today I heard? Mr. McLaughlin responded – Yes, infill maintenance is included, for all of the city's turf fields.

Mayor Burke – We are very excited about our partnership with Lesley University. It will provide learning labs for their students, as well as, ours

Ms. Van der Kloot – Could I please request an updated report on the Lesley project?

Mayor Burke – We have a 3 year contract with Lesley

Melanie McLaughlin – Thank you for air conditioning response this summer. It was very hot. The air conditioning campaign was to help

Mr. Ruseau – Have we heard anything on MSBA application?

Ms. Patterson – In December.

Mr. Ruseau – I heard Arlington already heard?

Ms. Patterson – The MSBA was only able to fund 15 projects last year, we were #40, and so they encouraged us to reapply for this year

Ms. DiBenedetto – Could Columbus School be used as possibility for camp?

Mayor Burke – Athletic Director Bob Maloney has already been investigating that possibility.

Ms. DiBenedetto - Also, who are the other members of the special education sub-committee?

Mayor Burke – We will update those lists

Mr. Ruseau – I would like to request a report from the new director of the Before/After School Programs at our next meeting.

On the motion from the original paper to accept the building & grounds report, with requests to follow up on pool report, AC systems, and Lesley University improvements, along with scheduling a meeting for Roberts playground. Motion carries.

Ms. DiBenedetto – I would like to request that the band room be dedicated to Mrs. Lena DiGiantomasso. Can I make a motion?

Ms. Van der Kloot – Not at this time. There is a policy for this. I believe it begins with a committee of the whole. It cannot be done from the floor. We need a little more information. We are all in favor, but there is a process. I'll look into it and will report back at next meeting. Then we can send it to a committee of the whole.

Ms. DiBenedetto – It would be good if we could move quickly. A committee of the whole prior to our next meeting?

Mayor Burke – If the policy allows, sure

Motion to revert to regular order of business.

Report on Administrative Meetings – Associate Superintendent Diane Caldwell

- Dr. Edouard-Vincent has a passion to get into our classrooms and that will be a priority of hers. She shared her identity tree. Directors updated us on new initiatives and we were updated on social emotional learning initiatives
- We hired a lot of new staff. It will be an exciting new year.

Mr. Ruseau – I was at the 1st day of administrative meetings. When can I obtain a copy of the CPR? Ms. Medaglio responded probably in the next few weeks.

Mr. Ruseau – Can we get copies of it?

Mayor Burke – Yes, we will.

Ms. DiBenedetto – Is Bistro open yet?

Superintendent Dr. Edouard-Vincent responded that our culinary students have just begun utilizing the space. Also the space was used for students who were in hot classrooms. We are hoping to open it to the general public in early October.

Ms. Caldwell – We have also utilized the Bistro for our administrative meetings, as well as, our meeting with Lesley University last week.

Ms. Mustone – I wanted to announce that the MHS Band will be performing music from the Greatest Showman at halftime during the MHS football game tomorrow night.

Mayor Burke – The MHS Band has been great. They also performed at Dave McGillivray Day and for the Fox 25 Zip Trip.

Ms. Van der Kloot – Thank you for all of the work you have done Diane.

Motion to place Administrative Meetings Report on file – Motion passes

Report on Enrollment Numbers – Ms. Caldwell – So included in your packets are a few days' worth of enrollment. In addition, I provided you with additional numbers tonight, as kindergarten began. You will notice that the Columbus Kindergarten numbers are up this year. Please note the parent information center is very busy and still registering students.

Ms. DiBenedetto – Roberts Kindergarten numbers look high to me.

Ms. Caldwell – The Roberts has full time kindergarten aides, plus connect students. Also all EL students are counted in classes.

Ms. DiBenedetto – Roberts grade 3 numbers are high

Ms. Caldwell – We do try to move students around, if we can.

Ms. DiBenedetto – Emergency cards by parents...isn't it all on Schoolbrains?

Headmaster Paul D'Alleva – Within system, you can print parent information sheets

Ms. Caldwell – We will look into the elementary emergency card policy

Ms. DiBenedetto – I would like the parent information center to be more streamlined. And I'd like the EL Department to assist and welcome new students.

Ms. Caldwell – We are looking to streamline the process and possibly extend the hours at the Parent Information Center.

Mayor Burke – We are pleased to have fresh eyes looking at things in the district

Mr. D'Alleva – Jasper Su can provide a student perspective on Schoolbrains

Mr. Su – I can check my grades and teachers can post assignments.

Mr. Ruseau – Grade 6 enrollments are exactly the same between both schools?

Ms. Caldwell – Yes those numbers are true. McGlynn has 2 more coming in

Mr. Ruseau – Do we know if students left district when they didn't get the middle school they wanted?

Ms. Caldwell – I don't know the answer to that

Mr. Ruseau – I'm confused by 2nd page. This is enrollment or is it attendance?

Ms. Caldwell – Please look at the district attendance on page 1. Those are who are enrolled.

M. Van der Kloot – What is maximum enrollment of schools? We need maximum enrollment, rather than a snapshot of a day. Then maybe we can see if we lost students. I'm assuming that an updated report will be forthcoming as the weeks go on.

Ms. Kreatz – What's the vocational breakdown, meaning how many of our students are at Minuteman and Essex? Also how many outside the district students do we have?

Ms. Patterson – We have (3) at Minuteman, (2) at Essex and we have (9) students from Everett enrolled at MVTHS.

Motion on floor to accept enrollment report – Motion passes

Report on Summer Program – Ms. Caldwell – schools were very busy with the summer fun camp, vocational camp, EL camp, summer school and middle school tech camp, etc.

Ms. DiBenedetto – 1st summer of EL Program Camp. I got great feedback. People were very happy.

Director of EL, Mr. Paul Texiera – Yes, students got to attend STEM camp at Hanscom for (1) week. They were able to build pieces of space station with a 3-D printer, and do other STEM focused activities.

Ms. Caldwell – We will provide you with the vocational update on summer programs for 8th graders.

Motion to place report on summer programs on file – Motion passes

Report on new Teacher Induction Program – Director of Curriculum Ms. Bernadette Ricciardelli presented the report, stating the new part of the induction was that we allowed the new teachers to spend the Friday of induction week in their classrooms, so they could get them ready. I would like to thank Donna Laskey, 4th grade teacher at McGlynn, for being the mentor coordinator for the district.

Motion to accept report on new teacher induction and place on file – Motion carries.

Report on Transportation – Ms. Patterson reported that it was a successful start, with less bus concerns than last year. The bus routes have been updated from the ones in your packet.

Ms. Van der Kloot – Thank you for providing buses to supplement MBTA buses during summer hours.

Ms. DiBenedetto – Are there any safety issues where buses stop?

Ms. Kreatz – Thank you for putting the information on the blog and website. I only received 1 inquiry and Kirsteen got right back to me

Ms. Mustone – Roberts parents are telling me that buses are overcrowded now that Kindergarten has started.

Ms. Patterson – We will work on that.

Vivian, a parent who lives on Washington Street, said the Hadley Place and Salem Street stop is definitely a safety issue. It's a McGlynn Elementary Bus.

Ms. Mustone – It's so difficult out there. A crossing guard from another district was actually killed. People are in hurry and not watching. They have to be so careful.

Mayor Burke – Do bus cameras see the cars that pass by?

Ms. Patterson – Not to my knowledge

Ms. Mustone – Would it be possible for police to focus on the Salem Street stop? Or maybe stop can be re-configured?

Ms. Patterson – We will review our options.

Motion to accept the transportation report – Motion passes

Report on Personnel Updates – Ms. Patterson –There has been significant staffing updates within the district including new hires, rehires, transfers, resignations and retirements. Additionally, we have hired a Human Resources Coordinator, Kate Green.

Motion to accept personnel report – motion carries.

Recommendation to approve Curtis Tufts Scholarship – Ms. Patterson – The Palumbo Family is providing a scholarship to a Curtis Tufts student who plans to enter a 2 year, 4 year college or trade school upon graduation.

Ms. DiBenedetto – I move approval, but would request that we send a letter of thanks to the Palumbo Family.

Motion to accept this scholarship – Motion passes 7-0

Recommendation to accept donation from the Impact Church – Ms. Patterson – The church would like to make a donation of \$10,000 to the Medford Public Schools. An example of donation use would be to purchase supplies and paper, given the district no longer receives a donation from Staples.

Ms. DiBenedetto – Would there be any conflict as they are a renter within our district?

Ms. Patterson – No

Motion to approve the donation from Impact Church – Motion passes 7-0.

Mr. Ruseau – Would it be possible for the school store to provide school supplies for parents to purchase? Thinking if school store bought in bulk, they could offer parents better pricing?

Ms. Van der Kloot – In the past, PTO groups used to do that and buy in bulk. But it takes a lot of effort and time. It's beneficial, but who can do it?

Ms. DiBenedetto – What about DECA program at MVTHS? They could order school supplies and students could buy them or maybe the PTO'S can try doing it again. The supplies might have to be set up in a larger area.

Ms. Caldwell – We can speak to Mr. Fallon about it.

Mr. Su – Our school store is fairly small. They do sell some school supplies, but store doesn't have much space.

Ms. Mustone – Maybe we could look into the school budget purchasing all supplies. That's what Portsmouth, NH school district does. Cost is \$50 per student.

Mayor Burke – But it would probably mean taking that amount away from another line item in our budget

Ms. Van der Kloot – Was the marketing teacher position replaced at MVTHS?

Ms. Patterson – No. The need wasn't there.

Mr. Ruggiero – Parents could order supplies on line and then pick up their orders at the schools.

Ms. Kreatz – I wanted to note that there is no HVAC teacher at MVTHS. I was told that no one applied. Incoming students had to choose a different shop. I was also told that the industry is booming, so not many HVAC people want to leave industry to teach. Coop is available to Juniors/Seniors. But new students cannot pick HVAC. My concern is that these students might select Minuteman. So something we have to think about.

Mayor Burke – I know we have reached out to the unions.

Superintendent Dr. Edouard-Vincent – Vocational teachers are a challenge, for they can make so much more money by working in the field. So it's hard to maintain and/or find teachers. Mr. Fallon has been trying.

Ms. DiBenedetto – I know the trades have been struggling to get young people interested in it as a potential job. My husband is in the construction trades. They make great money. I would hate to see any of our programming close. Maybe we could look outside the box and offer classes at night if necessary?

Mayor Burke – I would like to offer our congratulations once again to our heroic students from the Andrews Middle School: Jacob Wright and Zach Bertocchi.

Mayor Burke – Please stand as we offer a moment of silence in memory of Mr. Richard A. McGlynn, Ms. Claire Lynette Freda, Mr. John Bailey, Sr., and Mr. John Lynch, Sr. – all family members of the Medford Public Schools community.

Motion to adjourn 10:23 PM – Motion passes

